

kram rockets, and Agnikul Cosmos, known for its 3D-printed Agnilet engines, are making a mark, as are Dhruva Space's nanosatellites and Bellatrix's propulsion systems.

Isro's successful Chandrayaan-3 mission saw substantial contributions from private entities such as Ananth Technologies, Centum Electronics, and TCE.

Sanjay Kumar, CEO of Geospatial World, a platform that promotes geospatial technology, says users want more capable satellites for communication, Earth observation, and navigation. "For the world's most populous country, grassroots impact is crucial," says Kumar.

POLICY & REGULATION

National and international regulations are needed to oversee space activities and promote responsible use. Experts anticipate that such policies, supported by government funding, will advance space exploration and technology.

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman announced a dedicated venture capital fund of ₹1,000 crore in her FY25 Union Budget.

Anirudh A Damani, Managing Partner of Artha Venture Fund, says the fund is expected to attract substantial private investments, encourage entrepreneurial ventures, and advance India's position. "The government's venture capital fund will boost the space economy, while the R&D fund recognises that the space economy will be at the forefront of India's ascent," says Damani.

The Indian government reckons the geospatial sector will cross ₹63,000 crore by 2025.

Prakash says that Isro's NavIC, an autonomous satellite navigation system which provides accurate position information services to users in India and the surrounding region, could give GPS a run for its money.



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PAWAN GOENKA
CHAIRMAN, IN-SPACe



"[We] see a future of end-to-end missions where the government is only a regulator... By 2047, we see multiple global leaders from India"

SRINATH RAVICHANDRAN
CO-FOUNDER & CEO, AGNIKUL COSMOS

DEFENCE AND TELECOM

Geospatial intelligence and satellite-based surveillance have become important national security and strategic decision-making tools.

The GSAT-20 mission, led by Isro, will offer over 50 Gbps of bandwidth, enhancing high-speed satellite connectivity and addressing connectivity challenges in underserved regions, says Prakash.

The National Digital Communications Policy (NDCP) 2024 will set targets, such as connecting 650,000 villages using satellite technology.

Pawan Goenka, Chairman of IN-SPACe, says the strong demand for Earth observation data will benefit agriculture, energy, marine and road infrastructure.

IN-SPACe ropes in the private

sector to work in a robust regulatory environment. Goenka's agency sees growth in Ground Station as a Service (GSaaS) and Satellite as a Service (SataaS).

"The trends we are witnessing today in India's space sector are laying the groundwork for a transformative future," the IN-SPACe Chairman says.

Srinath Ravichandran, Co-founder & CEO of AgniKul Cosmos, which shot to fame with a 3D-printed customisable launch vehicle, sees a future of end-to-end missions where the government is only a regulator. "By 2047, I see multiple global leaders from India," says Ravichandran. **BT**

@neetu_csharma